

2	(a)	Gravitational potential energy is taken to be <u>zero at infinity</u> and <u>gravitational forces are attractive</u>. Since the <u>external agent is applying a force in the opposite direction relative to the displacement</u> made by the mass, negative work is done by the external agent.	[B1] [B1]
	(b) (i)	At infinity, kinetic energy and gravitational potential energy of probe is zero. By conservation of energy, the <u>minimum kinetic energy</u> required to for probe from surface to reach infinity is $\frac{GMm}{R_E}$ Since E is smaller than minimum required Kinetic energy, the probe cannot travel to deep space. Thought Process: - Calculate/determine the minimum energy required for probe to travel to infinity from surface. - Compare the minimum energy required with the energy of probe. Comment Note: At surface, $KE + GPE = 0$ (Assume very far) By COE, Energy on Earth = Energy at infinity $KE_s + GPE_s = 0$ $KE_s = -GPE = \frac{GMm}{R_E}$	[M1] [A1]
	(ii)	By conservation of energy Energy at surface = Energy at that point Initial KE + Initial GPE = final GPE + final KE $\frac{3}{4} \frac{GMm}{R_E} + (-\frac{GMm}{R_E}) = (-\frac{GMm}{R}) + 0$ $-\frac{1}{4R_E} = -\frac{1}{R}$ $R = 25.7 \times 10^6 \text{ m}$ OR Loss in KE = Gain in GPE $\frac{3GMm}{4R_E} = \frac{GMm}{R_E} - \frac{GMm}{R}, \text{ note } R_E < R$ $R = 25.7 \times 10^6 \text{ m}$	[C1] [B1] [A1]
	(iii)	Earth rotate in the <u>West to East</u> direction. Space probe launch in this direction will have an initial velocity, thus it has some initial KE, and not zero.	[B1] [A1]